

MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

Middle School | Unit 11

Prefixes ex- & e-



Today I am learning that the prefixes ex- and e- often carry the idea out, from or away.

1 Learn the Meaning

The Latin prefix ex- often means out or from. In some related words it appears as the shorter form e-. Looking at the root and the whole word helps us work out the meaning.

export
carry/send out

eject
throw out

extract
pull or draw out

emit
send out

2 Build the Word

Use the root clue and the correct prefix form. Build the word, then write a short meaning clue.

Root clue	Prefix	New word	Meaning clue
port (carry)	ex-		
tract (pull)	ex-		
pel (drive)	ex-		
ject (throw)	e-		
mit (send)	e-		

3 Read and Notice

Read the passage below.

Our science group investigated how matter can move out of one place and into another. First, we used a syringe to extract a small sample of coloured water from a container. We then watched a pump expel air through a narrow tube. When the pressure rose, a stopper was ejected from the opening and landed safely in a tray. The teacher explained that the words extract, expel and eject all carry a sense of movement outward. Next, we studied a diagram of a volcano. During an eruption, a volcano can emit gases, ash and heat, while rock may be ejected high into the air. Scientists extract information from samples and use instruments to record what the volcano emits. We also discussed how countries export materials and products by sending them out to other places. As we compared the words, we noticed that ex- is sometimes shortened to e- in older word structures. The exact meaning of a modern word cannot always be guessed from the prefix alone, so we used the root clue and the sentence context together. We added erupt and evacuate to our notes because both can suggest something moving or being moved outward. In an emergency drill, people evacuate a room by moving out to a safe place; when a volcano erupts, material breaks out from below the surface. We finished by writing a short explanation beside each example. By the end, we could explain how the idea of out, from or away connects the word family and why the root and context still matter.



Highlight the ex- and e- words. Circle the prefix and underline a root or related word when you can.

4 Word Detective

Choose one ex- or e- word from the passage and investigate its structure and meaning.

- Write a target word from the passage.

- Which prefix form does it use: ex- or e-?

- What root or related word clue can you identify?

- How does out/from/away connect to its meaning?

5 Sort the Words

Sort the words by the spelling of the prefix.

export extract expel exclude

eject emit erupt evade

ex-

e-

6 Use It in Writing



Complete the sentence starters.

- The prefix ex- can give me a clue that something _____

- Use one ex- or e- word in your own sentence.



Parent check

Tick the skills your learner has demonstrated.

- ☐ Recognises the ex-/e- prefix family
- ☐ Explains the out/from/away meaning clue
- ☐ Uses a root or related word to investigate meaning
- ☐ Reads and uses target words in context



Capture idea:

Find an ex- or e- word in a book or information text. Record the word, a root clue and what the whole word means.